

Chapter 70 - Part 1

After Su Meiqi finished saying this, only Zhou Yi'an let out a light snort in the office.

It wasn't mockery, just pure annoyance at Su Meiqi.

Su Meiqi bared her fangs and brandished her claws¹, wanting to punch someone, but Zhou Yi'an poked her with a pen, aiming at her hand. "Don't touch me. Do you still want to interview or not?"

"It's definitely ruined." Su Meiqi gritted her teeth. "You've already exposed my identity, how am I supposed to get into this company?!"

"But I still got in." Zhou Yi'an said.

Su Meiqi: "....."

In less than two seconds, she sat properly in the chair across from the interviewer, incredibly well-behaved.

Meanwhile, Xu Qingzhu looked at Su Meiqi very seriously. According to the resume, she was a year younger than her, had gone abroad to study design at the graduate level, and had been back in the country for a year.

She could remember these details after reading them just once.

Right now, she was mainly looking at Su Meiqi's face—delicate features, fair skin, with the sense of a beautiful girl who had walked out of an anime.

Mainly, there was a spirited energy about her.

Before she could say anything, Su Meiqi spoke to Zhou Yi'an again: "Sister Zhou, your teacher isn't called Su Yao anymore."

"I know." Zhou Yi'an looked down at the portfolio, twirling the pen between her slender fingers. "But the name Su Yao is still remembered by people."

"What use is that?" Su Meiqi scoffed lightly. "Can reporting her name get me exempted from the interview? She hasn't emerged from retirement in how many years."

Zhou Yi'an: "Anyway, it's more useful than reporting your own name."

Su Meiqi: "....."

A few seconds later, Su Meiqi said through gritted teeth: "Just wait, I'll definitely beat you once in the future!"

"Wait until your next life then." Zhou Yi'an's tone was quite irritating. "When have you ever beaten me since childhood?"

Su Meiqi: ".....How infuriating."

Zhou Yi'an glanced at her. "Are you here for an interview? How can you talk to the interviewer like this?"

"You're not the main interviewer." Su Meiqi said: "Can you stop using a tiger's skin² to bully people? Using a chicken feather as an arrow of authority³, looking like a petty person who's achieved success."

Zhou Yi'an: "....."

"You can leave now." Zhou Yi'an said: "There's no way you'll pass the interview."

"Hey!" Su Meiqi was so angry she immediately became irritable.

But before she could argue with her again, Xu Qingzhu, who had been quiet the whole time, said: "Keep her."

Her cool voice carried decisive efficiency without any hesitation, and she maintained absolute rationality when speaking. "I really like your work and design philosophy."

Su Meiqi was stunned, still in a dazed state.

Instead, Zhou Yi'an casually looked at Xu Qingzhu and said coldly: "You'd better think clearly—she's the heiress of Haiwei Jewelry."

"I even dared to hire you." Xu Qingzhu looked at her, radiating confidence from within, and smiled. "So what if she's the heiress of a rival company? Looking at it positively, I've captured a hostage."

Su Meiqi's face immediately fell. "Sister Xu, I'm really here to find work. I don't want to go back to my family's company—I'd be tortured to death by my dad... I definitely won't leak company secrets. If you still don't think it's acceptable, I can sign an additional confidentiality agreement."

"No need to sign a confidentiality agreement." Xu Qingzhu said: "It will be in your employment contract, the same as all other employees. You won't be treated differently. Of course, if you go around announcing that you're the heiress of Haiwei Jewelry, then that's beyond my consideration."

"Ah, definitely not." Su Meiqi immediately explained: "It's only because Sister Zhou is here that I was exposed, otherwise I could keep my mouth shut until I resign."

Who would want the company's people to know they're the heiress of a rival company for no reason?!

And also.....

Su Meiqi showed her bracelet. "Look, even the products I use are from your company."

"What a coincidence." Xu Qingzhu smiled. "This design was created by your Sister Zhou."

Su Meiqi: "....."

"We're really enemies." Su Meiqi sighed.

Zhou Yi'an: "Please don't, let's pretend we don't know each other."

Xu Qingzhu looked at the two of them, then said: "You can go home and wait for news first. HR will send you an email."

Su Meiqi nodded frantically, but before leaving the office, she said to Zhou Yi'an: "Sister Zhou, are you coming to my house for dinner tonight? My aunt is sick again."

Zhou Yi'an pursed her lips: "Doesn't she get sick at this time every year?"

Su Meiqi: "....."

She was angry. "Can you accumulate some verbal virtue⁴ for yourself? This year it's just a simple cold."

Zhou Yi'an lazily said, "Got it, I'll go."

After she left, only Xu Qingzhu and Zhou Yi'an remained in the office.

Zhou Yi'an had already prepared herself to be questioned, but Xu Qingzhu flipped through the resumes in her hands and directly called the next person's name.

Zhou Yi'an: "....."

She really could keep her composure.

Footnotes:

¹ **Bared her fangs and brandished her claws (張牙舞爪)** - A Chinese idiom describing someone acting in an aggressive, threatening, or overbearing manner.

² **Using a tiger's skin (扯着虎皮)** - Part of a Chinese idiom meaning to use borrowed authority or power to intimidate others; pretending to have more power than one actually does.

³ **Using a chicken feather as an arrow of authority (拿着雞毛當令箭)** - A Chinese idiom meaning to treat something trivial as if it were very important; using a small amount of authority to lord it over others.

⁴ **Accumulate some verbal virtue (積點口德)** - A Chinese expression meaning to watch one's words and speak more kindly; to build up good karma through one's speech rather than saying harsh or mean things.